

Aijia Zhang

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Research Interests

Empirical Corporate Finance, Corporate Governance, Foreign Institutional Investors, Investor-Firm Interactions, Corporate Innovation, Textual Analysis, and Chinese Capital Markets.

Education

University of Glasgow <i>PhD in Finance Programme</i> Expected Graduate Time: 2026 December	10/2022–Present Glasgow, UK
University of Glasgow <i>Master of Science in Management with International Finance with Distinction</i>	01/2021–03/2022 Glasgow, UK
Beijing Normal - Hong Kong Baptist University United International College (UIC) <i>Bachelor of Business Administration (Honours) in Applied Economics</i>	09/2016–06/2020 Zhuhai, China

Research

- **Foreign Institutional Investors' Site Visits and Tunnelling** (*Job Market Paper*)
This study investigates whether and how foreign institutional investors' (FIIs) site visits affect tunnelling through inter-corporate loans. Using all Chinese firms listed in the Shenzhen Stock Exchange from 2012 to 2022, we find that FIIs' site visits significantly curb tunnelling across three different measures of site visits. By performing propensity score matching and multi-period difference-in-difference analysis, we suggest this relation is causal. This effect is more pronounced when FIIs hold larger shareholdings, as their more intensive and frequent visits complement each other in mitigating tunnelling problems. The curbing effect of FIIs' site visits on tunnelling is more significant than that of site visits by other institutional investors, including Hong Kong, Macao, and Taiwan (HMT), Sino-foreign, and mainland institutional investors. Finally, we show that FIIs play an effective monitoring role if they visit in groups rather than alone. The study contributes to the literature on tunnelling problems and the disciplining role of FIIs in weak institutional environments.
- **Foreign Institutional Investors and Underperforming CEOs: Evidence from Chinese Listed Firms** (*with Martin Strieborny*)
- **Investor-Firm Interactions and Corporate Innovation: Evidence from China**

Conference Presentations

2026:	
Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting	Tampa, Florida, USA
Asian Finance Association (AsianFA) Annual Meeting	Seoul, South Korea
Discussant: "Motivations Behind Shareholder Proposals: Signaling or Real Changes? Evidence from ESG Issues"	
European Financial Management Association (EFMA) Annual Meeting	Kristiansand, Norway
Discussant: "Corporate Cultural Evolution: Cross-Sectional and Time-Series Determinants of Corporate Culture"	
2025:	

Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting	Vancouver, Canada
<i>Discussant: "Classified Boards, Debt Contracting, and Firm Value: Evidence from a Quasi-Natural Experiment"</i>	
Financial Management Association (FMA) European Conference	Limassol, Cyprus
<i>Discussant: "CEO Marital Status and Firm Diversification"</i>	
European Financial Management Association (EFMA) Annual Meeting	Athens, Greece
<i>Discussant: "Learning from News, Information Flow, and Financial Markets"</i>	
Chinese Economic Association (CEA) Annual Conference	Glasgow, UK

Academic Services

University of Glasgow **01/2025–Present**
Organizer, Internal Seminars for Finance PhDs *Glasgow, UK*

- Organise a seminar series in which finance PhD students present their research and receive feedback, and invite faculty members to discuss their own papers or share job market insights.

University of Glasgow **10/2023–Present**
Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA)

- Course: Foundations of International Corporate Finance (postgraduate course).
Explain key concepts in international corporate finance, including agency conflicts, mergers and acquisitions, and the time value of money. Provide guidance on effectively reading and interpreting corporate finance literature.

Awards, Grants, and Certificates

£500 Employability Funding, Adam Smith Business School (PhD)	2025
CFA Level I Pass	2020
Academic Excellence Scholarship, First Class (Undergraduate)	2019/2020
Academic Excellence Scholarship, Second Class (Undergraduate)	2018/2019

Skills

Technicals: Python, Matlab, Stata, EViews, SPSS, LaTeX and all Microsoft-based software

Databases: CSMAR (China Stock Market & Accounting Research), CNRDS (Chinese Research Data Services), Wind, Qichacha, Bloomberg, BoardEx

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), Korean (Intermediate)

References

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